

LEON R. DARDEN

AI Solutions Architect Lithonia, GA 30058 | (678) 763-0580 | leonrdarden@gmail.com

Digital Resume: leonrdarden.com/resume Portfolio: leonrdarden.com/portfolio LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/leon-darden-686899a5

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Strategic and results-driven AI Solutions Architect with over 15 years of experience in systems support, technical operations, and client-facing solutions. Recently completed the comprehensive Google AI Professional suite, specializing in the integration of Large Language Models (LLMs) to solve enterprise challenges. Proven track record in optimizing complex workflows via SAP, automating communications, and designing high-fidelity AI-native applications. Expert at bridging the gap between raw AI capabilities and user-centric business value.

DISTINGUISHED CREDENTIALS

- **Google AI Professional Certificate** (Feb 2026) *Advanced 7-Course Specialization, Google Cloud* Mastery of the end-to-end AI lifecycle, LLM architecture, strategic business planning, and AI-native application deployment.
- **Google Prompting Essentials** (Jan 2026) *Mastery Certificate, Google Cloud* Expertise in multi-turn dialogue optimization, constraint-based engineering, and preventing model hallucinations for enterprise reliability.

TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

- **AI/LLM:** Prompt Engineering, Gemini Pro Integration, Generative AI Strategy, LLM Workflow Automation.
- **Development:** React.js, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5/CSS3, Tailwind CSS, API Integration (REST).

- **Enterprise:** SAP ERP, CRM Systems (ACT, Enteract), Data Analysis, Technical Troubleshooting.
- **Design:** Multi-modal Asset Generation, Brand Strategy, Adobe Creative Suite.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Researcher | AI Solutions Development *Stonecrest, GA | 2024–Present*

- Dedicated 2,000+ hours to intensive upskilling in Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, and Full-stack development.
- Architected and launched a live digital portfolio showcasing integrated Gemini AI solutions.
- Developed custom logic for automated branding and voice-activated data logging systems.

Operations Solutions Specialist | Live Ops / Duke Energy *Lithonia, GA | 2020–2024*

- Managed high-volume utility data and billing functions utilizing SAP to ensure 99% accuracy in complex account management.
- Provided technical assistance to internal contractors, translating utility protocols into actionable operational steps.
- Optimized customer care workflows by implementing improved problem-solving frameworks for sensitive utility escalations.

Client Solutions Consultant | Vertex / Georgia Natural Gas *Kennesaw, GA | 2008–2014*

- Consistently ranked in the Top 5% of production, leveraging data-driven sales strategies to drive new business growth.
- Collaborated on design concepts for the GNG App, utilizing artistic skills to improve mobile user engagement.
- Maintained a 65%–85% close ratio through advanced needs assessment and technical product knowledge.

Systems Support Analyst | New Health Care Management *Atlanta, GA | 2004–2008*

- Performed large-scale data conversions and repairs of critical customer data to support cross-departmental operations.
- Identified and resolved file process errors that resulted in significant cost savings and system integrity.
- Lead trainer for staff on SAP processing software, ensuring seamless adoption of new technical workflows.

EDUCATION

- **Telecommunications Management**, DeVry Institute of Technology (Decatur, GA)

- **Graphic & Commercial Arts Certificate**, Occupational Education Center (Decatur, GA)

Finding the right connections in the Atlanta tech scene requires a mix of niche job boards and direct outreach to the "Silicon Peach" ecosystem. Since you are targeting **Prompt Engineering** and **AI Solutions** roles, here is a curated list of resources and information to share with your career strategist.

Top AI-Focused Job Boards (2026)

These platforms move faster than LinkedIn and are dedicated to the AI/ML space:

- **AI Jobs (.net)**: The gold standard for pure AI roles (Prompt Engineering, LLM Ops, and AI Architecture).
- **JobBoardAI**: Specifically focuses on AI startups and builders.
- **Remotive / HiringCafe**: Excellent for finding high-paying **Remote** roles that may be headquartered outside of Georgia but hire locally.
- **Uxcel**: Perfect if you want to highlight the intersection of AI Solutions and User Experience (UX).

Company	Focus Area	Location/Mode	Why they are a fit
Sema4.ai	Agentic AI	Atlanta (Midtown)	Deep focus on LLM evaluations and AI agents.
OneTrust	AI Governance	Atlanta (HQ)	Leading the way in ethical AI and data privacy.
Pindrop	AI Security	Atlanta (Midtown)	High-growth startup specializing in voice-based AI.

Flock Safety	Computer Vision	Atlanta (Buckhead)	Using AI for public safety; huge local employer.
Salesloft	AI Sales Strategy	Atlanta (Midtown)	Integrating GenAI into B2B sales workflows.
Nymbus	Fintech AI	Atlanta (Remote/Hybrid)	Hiring "AI-First" engineers for the banking sector.

Gemini said

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Innovative Companies Hiring in Atlanta

Below are current companies in the Atlanta area (or with major hubs there) that are actively scaling their AI teams:

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Hiring Manager Outreach & "Bit" Info

For your career strategist to use in cold outreach, here is a "cheat sheet" for identifying and contacting the right people.

How to Find the Name

1. **Search LinkedIn for:** "Head of AI [Company Name]" or "Director of Engineering [Company Name]".
2. **The "Reports To" Trick:** Look at the job description on the company site. It often says "This role reports to the **VP of Innovation**"—that is the name you need to find.

Guessing the Email Format

Most Atlanta tech firms use one of these three formats. If you have the manager's name (e.g., Jane Doe), try these:

- `j.doe@company.com`
- `jdoe@company.com`
- `jane.doe@company.com`

Strategist Tip: Use tools like **Apollo.io** or **Hunter.io** (free tiers available) to verify these patterns before hitting send.

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Local Networking "Hotspots"

If you want to meet these managers in person (or via their private Slack channels):

- **AI Tinkerers Atlanta:** A practitioner-only group that meets at the Biltmore or Tech Square.
- **Atlanta Tech Village (ATV):** The heart of the startup scene in Buckhead. Even if a job isn't posted, the companies there are almost always looking for AI talent.
- **Claude Coders / AI Agents Network:** Specific meetups for those building with Claude and Agentic AI.

Gemini said

Here is a high-impact outreach template designed for an AI Solutions Architect. This draft is structured to highlight technical certifications and the ability to bridge the gap between complex AI models and business value—exactly what hiring managers in the Atlanta tech scene are looking for.

Subject: AI Solutions Architect | Specializing in Agentic Workflows & Prompt Engineering

To: [Hiring Manager Name]

Company: [Company Name]

Hi [Hiring Manager Name],

I've been following [Company Name]'s recent work in [mention a specific project, e.g., **Agentic AI or Voice Security**], and I'm reaching out because your team's focus on innovative AI implementation aligns perfectly with my background as an **AI Solutions Architect**.

I specialize in designing scalable AI workflows and high-performance prompt engineering. Having recently completed the **Google AI Professional Certificate** and the **Google Prompting Essentials Specialization**, I focus on building "AI-first" solutions that don't just use LLMs, but optimize them for accuracy and cost-efficiency.

A few ways I can contribute to your team:

- **Prompt Architecture:** Developing advanced prompt frameworks to reduce hallucinations and improve output reliability.
- **Workflow Integration:** Bridging the gap between raw AI capabilities and user-centric application design.
- **Strategic Implementation:** Identifying high-value use cases for Generative AI within existing business ecosystems.

I'm based in the **Atlanta area** and would love to discuss how my technical background and recent certifications can help [Company Name] stay ahead of the curve.

Are you open to a brief conversation next Tuesday or Wednesday?

Best regards,

Leon R. Darden

AI Solutions Architect

[Link to Portfolio/GitHub]

[LinkedIn Profile URL]

[Phone Number]

Strategic Tips for Your Career Strategist:

1. **The "Local" Advantage:** Since you are in **Lithonia/Stonecrest**, emphasizing that you are an Atlanta-based professional is a major plus for "Hybrid" roles at companies in Midtown or Buckhead (like OneTrust or Pindrop).
2. **Portfolio Focus:** Ensure your GitHub or portfolio prominently features your "Hydro-Scan" or "Watz 4 Dinner" prototypes. These are concrete "Proof of Concept" (POC) examples that prove you can move from a prompt to a working application.
3. **The "Agentic" Buzzword:** In 2026, companies aren't just looking for people who can talk to ChatGPT; they want "Agentic AI" specialists. Using terms like **"Agentic Workflows"** in the subject line will significantly increase your open rate.
4. **Follow-up Cadence:** If you don't hear back, have your strategist send a "bump" email 4 days later. Use a simple: *"Hi [Name], just following up to see if my background in AI Solutions Architecture might be a fit for your current roadmap. Thanks!"*